

OUTRAGEOUS OPENNESS

Letting the Divine Take the Lead

A STUDY COMPANION

Based on the audiobook by
TOSHA SILVER

THE ARC

Three Movements

Tosha Silver's book is a mosaic of short, funny, luminous true stories, all circling one idea: that a force of love is waiting to guide your life in the most practical way — if you know how to invite it in. This companion gathers her sixteen chapters into a single arc that moves from surrender, to daily practice, to embodiment.

MOVEMENT I

Making the Divine Your Source

The turning — surrender

Before anything else, Tosha turns the whole idea of security on its head. No person, job, market, or plan can be your refuge. The first movement is the great reorientation: making the Divine itself your source, and learning to stop trying to run your life “without God.”

Chapters 1–3

MOVEMENT II

Letting the Divine Lead

The daily practice — following

Surrender becomes a set of everyday tools. The second movement is the practice: invoking Divine Order, offering worries to a God Box, following the inner tug and the breadcrumb trail, trading worry for blessings, and clearing whatever blocks the flow.

Chapters 4–9

MOVEMENT III

Becoming Who You Are

The living — embodiment

The path comes home to you. The third movement is embodiment: taking back your power, loving and telling the truth, inviting mundane miracles, staying present, embracing your whole contradictory nature, and finally making your work an act of love — resting in the unfolding.

Chapters 10–16

MOVEMENT



Making the Divine Your Source

The turning – surrender

Before anything else, Tosha turns the whole idea of security on its head. No person, job, market, or plan can be your refuge. The first movement is the great reorientation: making the Divine itself your source, and learning to stop trying to run your life “without God.”

01 Are You My Mother?

02 Shopping with God

03 When You Know the One, Anything Can Come

CHAPTER 01

Are You My Mother?

The Divine as your true source

“A good traveler has no fixed plans, and is not intent on arriving.”

THE HEART OF IT

No person, place, or job can be your permanent refuge; when you make the Divine itself your source, you can hold everything with an open hand, letting what comes come and what goes go.

STORIES TO REMEMBER

- Reading the children’s book “Are You My Mother?” as a grown woman, Tosha saw the baby bird’s frantic search for a home as our own restless hunt for a refuge that no person or place can ever permanently give.
- An online spiritual-message company hired and then dropped her for filling her columns with stories and personalities; she believes God is the story itself — the Divine constantly “igniting roadside flares” to get our attention.
- Her lifelong terror of spiders broke the night she gently talked to a golf-ball-sized spider on her wall, offering it the ceiling while she took the bed; by morning it was gone, and a friend’s essay arrived saying arachnophobia comes from fear of one’s own power.
- Raised in a family with six rabbis, she once fell to pieces sobbing during the film “Agnes of God,” flooded with what felt like past-life love for Jesus — and now keeps an altar to Shiva, Kali, Ganesh, and the Shekhinah, “polyamorous” toward the Divine.

TOSHA’S TAKEAWAYS

- 1 Stop trying to make a job, relationship, or place your salvation — the moment you grip something as your source, you become its slave.
 - 2 Make the Divine your source and you move through life with lightness, letting what wishes to come come and what wishes to go go.
 - 3 The sacred lives inside the ordinary, personal details, not in sanitized sameness; your quirks and wounds are exactly where the Divine shows up.
 - 4 Every separation is an illusion — seeing the world as yourself dissolves fear, even of the thing you dread most.
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CHAPTER 02

Shopping with God

Surrender and Divine Order in daily life

“You’ll never find parking there ... without God.”

THE HEART OF IT

The single most important thing she learned was to stop functioning on her own strength and surrender to the Divine — invoking Divine Order, which says the perfect solution to any problem is already selected and you will be guided to it.

STORIES TO REMEMBER

- Her teenage game of adding “during sex” to any sentence grew up into a private game of adding “without God” — as in “it’s impossible to find the right job in this economy ... without God.”
- On the radio, an efficiency expert insisted procrastination could only be beaten by following all forty-four of his steps in exact order; she had to pull the car over, laughing at his mastery of doing it “without God.”
- Her friend Laurie panicked over her Northern California house as the recession deepened, checking Zillow obsessively; following four steps — release the personal focus, call in Divine Order, install the Divine as the true owner, and detach — she sold it through one Craigslist ad to a couple with a new baby for exactly the amount she needed.
- Stuck on a book proposal a writer offered to draft for over seven thousand dollars, she declined, invoked Divine Order in her car, and within a month a friend in New Mexico emailed her own proposal to use “like a map.”

TOSHA’S TAKEAWAYS

- 1** Invoke Divine Order: declare that the perfect solution is already chosen and you’ll be guided to it at the right time, in the right way — then let go.
 - 2** Notice how often you unconsciously try to force life “without God,” running from one self-styled expert to the next.
 - 3** Deliberately create unplanned space — let intuition lead an afternoon — and solutions to tangled problems tend to surface on their own.
 - 4** You don’t have to know the details of the answer; your job is to offer the problem sincerely and follow the leads as they appear.
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CHAPTER 03

When You Know the One, Anything Can Come

The Divine as your one Source; forgiveness reopens the flow

“There is a supply for every demand.”

THE HEART OF IT

When you make the Divine your one Source — not any person, job, or economy — the universe can use anything to meet your needs; and resentment blocks that flow, so forgiveness reopens it.

STORIES TO REMEMBER

- Asking for a sign during a rudderless summer, she met a striped gray snake in Calistoga that walked a full block beside her, and two days later a stranger let his emerald python coil around her shoulders — the snake being a symbol of death, rebirth, and the Shakti, telling her to let the old skin shed.
- Driving the Bay Bridge pondering all this, a huge white truck kept pace with her; its logo read “UniSource — Experience the Power of One,” and the tattooed driver waved. “Not even subtle.”
- Tony, a smooth shyster, vanished with five thousand dollars from her and each of her friends; while the others hunted him in rage, she prayed to forgive and named the Divine her only source — and six months later his rattled associate handed her an envelope of cash in an Emeryville café.
- Her musician friend Scott was snubbed by a guitarist he’d helped; told to drop his resentment because “she is not your source,” he randomly met the exact person he’d wanted to reach at a club a week later.

TOSHA’S TAKEAWAYS

- 1 Anchor in Divine Source: no person, place, or thing is your foundation — only the Divine, which can then use anything to supply you.
- 2 Resentment blocks the flow; forgiveness (which is not the same as condoning) simply sets you free and reopens the channel.
- 3 Ask for signs and watch for them — the universe answers, often with a wink, sometimes twice.
- 4 If one supply dries up, another always comes; stop gripping any single situation like a barnacle on a sinking boat.

MOVEMENT



Letting the Divine Lead

The daily practice — following

Surrender becomes a set of everyday tools. The second movement is the practice: invoking Divine Order, offering worries to a God Box, following the inner tug and the breadcrumb trail, trading worry for blessings, and clearing whatever blocks the flow.

- 04 Following the Inner Lead
- 05 Giving It All Up — The Death Advisor
 - 06 Be What You Seek
- 07 The Holiday Emergency Survival Kit
- 08 When in Doubt, Clean the Karma
- 09 Objects in Mirror Are Closer Than They Appear

CHAPTER 04

Following the Inner Lead

The God Box, the breadcrumb trail, and being a vessel

“Move, but don’t move the way fear makes you move.”

THE HEART OF IT

The universe is conscious and will guide you step by step if you ask and follow — through the God Box, the breadcrumb trail, and the felt inner pull — especially once you stop trying to be the doer and let yourself be a conduit.

STORIES TO REMEMBER

- The God Box: write each worry on a slip of paper and drop it in a container (any “highest wisdom” will do). She first used it apartment-hunting during a three-percent vacancy rate, and within a month her vet mentioned a place — she’s been there fifteen years.
- Her skeptical economist friend Don, who introduces her as his “wacky psychic pal,” admitted that at three in the morning during a snowstorm he woke to hear his roommate Joey scream his name twice and drove ten blocks to find Joey’s car buried in a snowdrift — then called it “coincidence” so he’d never have to question everything.
- Her friend Stephen fled San Francisco for “statistically safe” rural Washington to escape earthquakes — and Mount St. Helens erupted eleven miles from his new town, burying his belongings in ash; he never made a decision from fear again.
- Being a vessel: a celebrated French speaker who forgot her gift belonged to the Divine lost her voice for three months, until a dream asked “Who did your voice belong to?” — she offered it all back, and her voice returned.

TOSHA’S TAKEAWAYS

- 1 Use a God Box: physically offer each worry to a higher wisdom, and solutions arise when the mind stops grasping. Give it twenty-one days.
 - 2 Ask for guidance, then follow the breadcrumbs — some trails appear instantly, others take weeks while things line up.
 - 3 Don’t make decisions from fear; fear-driven moves tend to deliver the very disaster you fled.
 - 4 Shift from doer to conduit — “use me, let me be helpful” — and your true calling can arrive; forgetting the gift is on loan can cost you the gift.
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CHAPTER 05

Giving It All Up — The Death Advisor

Radical surrender and non-grasping

“When you make yourself into zero, your power becomes invincible.”

THE HEART OF IT

When you truly let go — of outcomes, of the ego’s agenda, even of life itself — you stop blocking the flow, and paradoxically everything becomes possible. Let death be your advisor.

STORIES TO REMEMBER

- Paula, a forty-ish Baltimore paralegal with no spiritual bent, was given three months to live with rare lymphoma; she paid off her debts, stopped useless conversations, told the truth, and followed her own clock — and when the cancer vanished in the third month, she found she could manifest and heal almost anything, because “when you no longer need anything, you can have everything.”
- Carol called daily wanting enlightenment yet seethed over unmet desires — a husband, wealth, a house, even Oprah — until Tosha suggested she take her vision boards and lists to the beach and burn them in a sacred fire, offering the whole mess to the Divine.
- The Law-of-Attraction craze produced many people like Carol; a friend joked that one bestseller was “the secret to more karma,” because manifesting with grasping breeds suffering as surely as night follows day.
- “Always go to the top”: tormented by an import house that sent the wrong armchair three times, she wrote the CEO a warm, detailed letter as if to a friend — and got a full refund plus the chair as a gift; she now applies that same directness to the Divine itself.

TOSHA’S TAKEAWAYS

- 1 Let death be your advisor — living as if you’ve already released everything strips away grasping and clears the channel for grace.
 - 2 Offer your desires up rather than badgering the universe with lists; ask for the highest plan instead of one specific outcome.
 - 3 Manifesting with attachment breeds suffering; align with Divine Order and what you truly need will come, far beyond the ego’s pyrotechnics.
 - 4 Move through the world with an open hand (aparigraha): let what wants to come come, what wants to go go — if it’s yours, it stays.
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CHAPTER 06

Be What You Seek

Your word and your state of mind create your world

“Thoughts are boomerangs — choose wisely what you throw.”

THE HEART OF IT

Prosperity depends not on your bank balance but on your state of mind and your words (the power of the word, matrika shakti); to receive abundance, embody it now rather than waiting for conditions to change.

STORIES TO REMEMBER

- Marie sold an internet company for millions yet called to complain she could barely survive on two million a year and regretted not selling for more; her “word of poverty became her law,” and she later declared bankruptcy.
- Meanwhile Laurie lives modestly in a true state of grace — parking spaces open, extra jobs appear, and a neighbor rents her home for exactly her travel money the day before she needs it; “the angels compete to help her.”
- After decades of writer’s block, a psychic predicted Tosha would soon write and find great happiness; she laughed (“my grocery lists?”), then finally invoked Divine Order over her block, and three months later stumbled into the column that launched everything.
- Her friend Dita casually stayed home from work “just because I felt like it,” and novelist Bryn, drowning in years of unanswered fan mail, wept with relief when told to simply bless the letters and burn them — “no is a complete sentence.”

TOSHA’S TAKEAWAYS

- 1 Guard your words: what you repeatedly say about money and life becomes your law — never call yourself broke.
 - 2 Abundance is a state to embody, not await; act generous now (even a dollar tithed) to draw flow into the present.
 - 3 Apply Divine Order to the very areas where you’ve relied on your own limited strength — that’s exactly where things stay stuck.
 - 4 Learn to say no; every well-placed no makes more room for the pleasure of saying yes.
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CHAPTER 07

The Holiday Emergency Survival Kit

Honoring the inner tug and reading the signs

“The next right step can be felt as a palpable inner pull.”

THE HEART OF IT

The next right action can be felt as a palpable inner pull; learn to honor it, ask for clear signs, and trust your first instincts about people and places.

STORIES TO REMEMBER

- At an overbooked Phoenix gate she felt a ferocious pull to volunteer her seat despite a Monday class she couldn't miss; a man beat her to it — then boarded anyway because another passenger left to chase an escaped cat, and he kept the free tickets, sitting beside her to reveal why her body had been yanking her up.
- Longing to be in Mexico for the Virgin of Guadalupe's December feast but too late to plan cheaply, she asked for a sign — and two days later met a young man in a knee-length Guadalupe T-shirt; her whole trip then flowed, every last-minute seat and room appearing.
- Her friend Jane ignored her gut at a Thanksgiving dinner and got “psychically vampired” by the charismatic, increasingly drunk hostess — it took a full day of Epsom-salt baths to wash off the toxic energy.
- A single line — “moving from a place of ease and effortlessness” — transformed a frazzled woman in a Pacific Heights grocery line who emailed it to herself and walked out radiant; “sometimes it doesn't take much.”

TOSHA'S TAKEAWAYS

- 1 Honor the inner tug — the felt bodily pull toward the next right step — even when logic can't explain it.
 - 2 Ask for clear signs when deciding, and add the prayer: if I'm about to head the wrong way, please stop me.
 - 3 Trust your first impressions of people; notice how you feel around them and, especially, how you feel after you leave them.
 - 4 Anchor your mind on a single calming thought and let the receptive mind absorb it, even if the critical mind disputes it.
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CHAPTER 08

When in Doubt, Clean the Karma

Releasing toxic ties and clearing space

“What you resist persists.”

THE HEART OF IT

Negative emotion binds you to the very people and situations you long to escape; a deliberate practice of release — and even ordinary decluttering — clears space for the Divine to enter.

STORIES TO REMEMBER

- Her client Julie, consumed with rage through a brutal divorce (even driving past her ex’s windows at night), worked a seven-step release — an unsent letter, burning it, an Epsom-salt bath, cleansing smoke, releasing his objects, praying for closure, and sending blessings — three full times, and a week later he suddenly conceded.
- Teaching Divine Order, she has students spend three weeks clearing homes, cars, purses, and wallets; Gina, a serious pack rat who had panic attacks at the thought, finally let friends haul away three truckloads — and a new job and a lost love returned. “How could the good even get in the door?”
- A woman clung to a beautiful Turkish rug from her tortured marriage until it sold at auction, whereupon inexplicable happiness flooded in and she flew to Hawaii; even Tosha felt a pang releasing her old Seinfeld tapes.
- Two days before surgery, an acquaintance “with the greatest love” phoned a lurid catalog of surgical disasters; Tosha absorbed the fear, then soaked in a lavender bath and learned “not to drink other people’s poison, even when it’s offered with love.”

TOSHA’S TAKEAWAYS

- 1 Release toxic ties deliberately — unsent letters, salt baths, cleansing smoke, and above all sending blessings — because resentment leashes you to what you want to escape.
 - 2 Create an intentional vacuum: clear the clutter so the spiritual work and the new good have room to arrive.
 - 3 Elevate an ordinary chore into an offering — clean a messy drawer as a template for sorting your own psyche.
 - 4 Guard your budding new life like a seedling; don’t pour others’ fear and negativity on it.
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CHAPTER 09

Objects in Mirror Are Closer Than They Appear

Trade worry for blessings; refuse forced manifestation

“Worry is the worst energy you can send someone you love.”

THE HEART OF IT

Worry is the worst energy you can send someone you love; replace it with blessings (metta). And anything forced into being through personal will is ill-gotten — call in Divine Order instead of commandeering outcomes.

STORIES TO REMEMBER

- Told that worry is a “black envelope filled with muck and skull bones,” a grandmother terrified about her daughter’s first pregnancy gathered friends to send nightly light instead; the daughter felt uplifted, and the birth went well.
- Practicing metta in a hellish post-office line, she blessed everyone waiting — and a translator arrived, the stalled line moved, and strangers began laughing.
- A cautionary tale from Florence Scovel Shinn: a woman who obsessively coveted another’s house helped hasten the owner’s death through sheer will, then reaped a nightmare including her own partner’s death — far better to say “bring the home that’s right for me.”
- Rescued from a dumpster: three years bedridden and spiritually bitter, Tosha found a glittering poster of Lakshmi, Ganesh, and Saraswati leaning against the basement trash where she’d thrown away her own faith; she hung it, cleaned her apartment, and her recovery began.

TOSHA’S TAKEAWAYS

- 1 The instant worry begins, send blessings instead — hold the person in light, day after day; it’s the best gift you can give anyone.
- 2 Use metta: pour peace and love to yourself, then to loved ones, then to the difficult, then to the world — and you become a divine conduit again.
- 3 Never force an outcome by personal will; “disaster” literally means against the stars — call in Divine Order and let the right thing come.
- 4 Even in your darkest hour, watch for the sign that you’re not abandoned — and treat your own suffering body with tenderness.

MOVEMENT



Becoming Who You Are

The living – embodiment

The path comes home to you. The third movement is embodiment: taking back your power, loving and telling the truth, inviting mundane miracles, staying present, embracing your whole contradictory nature, and finally making your work an act of love – resting in the unfolding.

- 10 Own Your Power (Or Someone Else Will)
- 11 Romantic Kismet – Marrying Kali
- 12 Mundane Miracles and Other Mysteries
- 13 Contestants Must Be Present to Win
- 14 The Higher Octave
- 15 Be Who You Are
- 16 Be What the World Needs

CHAPTER 10

Own Your Power (Or Someone Else Will)

Reclaim your voice, cut the cords, drop the victim

“Sometimes we turn our lives over to a petty dictator.”

THE HEART OF IT

Take back the power you unconsciously hand to angry strangers, controlling parents, draining friends, and fortune-tellers; another's rage is rarely about you, and your answers live inside you.

STORIES TO REMEMBER

- A woman erupted at Tosha for stepping out of an airport security line; instead of crumbling or firing back (her two old reactions), she found “door number three” — compassion, sensing someone who'd never been heard — and silently sent her good thoughts.
- To free herself from a demanding father's critical inner voice during a writing block, she took his hurtful letter to Ocean Beach, smashed a coconut on a wall, and — when the wind killed her lighter — found two young men tending a bonfire who helped her burn it, high-fiving her: “You are free, Mama.”
- Patty's “bad-weather friend” Mary adored her disasters and beamed when Patty's fiancé left the week she broke her hand — but turned resentful once Patty's life bloomed; “notice whether people fill you or drain you.”
- Patrice, dumped near fifty for a younger woman, dropped her victim story when her chart revealed a marriage that had been dead for years and that she'd long wanted out of; she stopped comparing herself, “pretended” she was beautiful as she was, and soon met a man who prized exactly that self-acceptance.

TOSHA'S TAKEAWAYS

- 1 When someone attacks, remember it's rarely personal — find the third option of compassion instead of collapse or counterattack.
 - 2 Free the inner hostage yourself; no one else can storm the gates of a parent's or a past's grip on your psyche.
 - 3 Notice who drains you versus who fills you — bless them and, if needed, let them go.
 - 4 Drop the victim story and stop comparing; the intuitive mind believes whatever you tell it, so speak your worth — and never hand your power to a reader.
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CHAPTER 11

Romantic Kismet — Marrying Kali

Love, karma, and telling the truth

“If you’re destined to be with someone, nothing can stop it.”

THE HEART OF IT

If a relationship is meant to be (bashert), nothing can stop it and you needn’t manipulate to earn it — so relax and be yourself; and in an age of lies, make your word match your actions.

STORIES TO REMEMBER

- Eli reunited with Elsa — the fiery Aries artist who, mid-blowout, sold all his clothes and his vintage motorcycle jacket at a consignment shop and moved out while he was away; “she’s a complete maniac, but she’s my maniac ... what more could you want if you choose to marry Kali.”
- Greg juggled two women in Denver, terrified of losing either, until they collided and both dumped him; invoking Divine Order finally let him tell the truth, and he ended up happily with someone who had the best of both.
- Janine fled San Francisco for a town in Alaska with an eighty-five-to-one male ratio; she kept doing “that Divine Order deal” anyway, met a vacationing man from twelve blocks from her own flat, and moved home in total heaven.
- On Valentine’s Day, sobbing in a phone booth over a breakup, a homeless man handed her a perfect white gardenia and said “Don’t cry, baby, it’ll all work out”; the next day she spent giving anonymous kindness — “best Valentine’s ever.”

TOSHA’S TAKEAWAYS

- 1 If it’s bashert, it will come — you don’t need to rope, trick, or “play it cool”; just be yourself.
 - 2 Invoke Divine Order over love: “the perfect partner is already selected and will arrive in the right time” — then stop hunting.
 - 3 Say what you mean; staying in a dead relationship “to spare” someone actually hobbles them from finding what’s right.
 - 4 Widen love beyond one person — become a force for love wherever you go, partnered or not.
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CHAPTER 12

Mundane Miracles and Other Mysteries

Inviting the miraculous into small and impossible things

“God will make a way out of no way.”

THE HEART OF IT

Calling in a miracle can open doors that linear logic never could; sometimes an obstacle is a hidden rescue, and “realism” can be terribly unrealistic.

STORIES TO REMEMBER

- Just healed and nearly broke, she walked past a San Francisco penthouse with Golden Gate views; the Syrian owner, who’d learned to read character on the Damascus streets by age four, rented it to her for two hundred dollars because he saw she’d survived a disaster and was “perfect” — for exactly the right three years.
- The errant bullet: having moved to the “statistically safest” neighborhood to be safe, a stray high-powered rifle round from a gang shootout two blocks away pierced her window inches above her head; had she stood a moment earlier, the officer said, she’d be dead.
- Amy and Todd searched months for a car, finally invoked Divine Order and fixed their old clunker — then spotted their dream green Forester at a stoplight, drove to the dealership in Endwell, New York, and found it sitting on the corner of Amy Road.
- Stuck in a bridge traffic jam blessing the delay (“all delays are beneficial”), she got home to find a drunk driver had pinballed into seven cars on her street twenty minutes earlier — right where she’d have been.

TOSHA’S TAKEAWAYS

- 1 Invite a miracle on anything, big or small — divine intercession opens what rationality can’t.
 - 2 Surrender the old before the new can come (fix the clunker), and watch the “celestial clockwork” wink at you.
 - 3 Bless delays and obstacles; you never know what larger nightmare they’re sparing you.
 - 4 Keep your mind open and awestruck — sometimes realism is terribly unrealistic.
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CHAPTER 13

Contestants Must Be Present to Win

Presence over escape; the Zen of ordinary life

“Be here now, be somewhere else later.”

THE HEART OF IT

Wanderlust and spiritual bypassing are ways of fleeing the present; the whole path can be practiced right where you are — even in your car — because God is in all the messy earthly details, and you must be present to receive.

STORIES TO REMEMBER

- A loud tourist “bagging” country after country in a Mission sushi bar left Tosha in “bottomless existential exhaustion”; stepping onto Valencia Street with nowhere to go, she felt giddy and alive among mariachi players and a heron-tattooed woman heading to yoga.
- The Zen of Traffic: trusting there’s another parking spot with your name on it, letting cars merge, blessing the driver who cuts you off (“that poor child never got enough lovin”).
- The very day she posted her “Zen of Traffic” column, her Prius was towed for parking five minutes early in cash-strapped San Francisco; nearly four hundred dollars later, refilling her emptied grocery cart “like Bill Murray in Groundhog Day,” she had to laugh at the test of living what she wrote.
- A “bearer of divine light” neighbor treated reality as a distraction — moving people’s wet laundry, leaving trash for “cosmic pickup” — and on moving out dragged the garage light strip down the road, plunging everyone’s cars into darkness.

TOSHA’S TAKEAWAYS

- 1 Stop chasing the world’s mirages; you may already have “seen it all” — the deeper adventure is learning to be still right where you are.
 - 2 Practice presence in the ordinary — ask through the day “where am I, what am I doing, am I breathing?” and root yourself like a tree.
 - 3 Turn driving into spiritual training: trust, generosity, being-with-what-is, abundance, compassion, and equanimity.
 - 4 Don’t use spirituality to bypass earthly life — God is in all the messy details; you have to be present to win.
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CHAPTER 14

The Higher Octave

Embrace your whole, contradictory nature

“If you don’t know it, you can’t blow it.”

THE HEART OF IT

You are not one flat “type”; you’re a complex, contradictory whole, and every part of you has a low and a high expression — the work is to embrace all of it and live your highest octave, like the scorpion evolving into eagle and phoenix.

STORIES TO REMEMBER

- A street mystic in Ojai told her in staccato bursts that she was “half and half everything — introvert, extrovert, young, old, woman, man,” then left to buy a burrito; it was so accurate she’d spent years trying to dissolve those paradoxes before realizing she was born to embrace them.
- The gay attorney with Libra planets who was “the world’s worst lawyer,” daydreaming makeovers mid-deposition, finally opened a New York boutique; the parts of a person are “guests at a cosmic party,” and the trick is letting each feel included.
- Scorpio’s three forms: a teenager blamed her sign for being “vindictive and ruthless,” and Tosha showed her the stinging scorpion can evolve into the clear-eyed eagle and finally the phoenix rising from the ashes.
- Teresa, a “warrior queen” with Mars on her Aries horizon, kept failing at “be soft and girly” advice until she stopped suppressing her nature and dated a man who said meeting someone that strong “was like winning the lottery.”

TOSHA’S TAKEAWAYS

- 1 Embrace your contradictions rather than dissolving them — you were born to hold all your conflicting parts.
 - 2 Every trait has a low and a high octave; choose the eagle and the phoenix over the stinging scorpion.
 - 3 Nothing in you is inherently “bad” — even “afflicted” energy is raw power that can help others or run wild.
 - 4 Express the music of your own soul, and the culture’s fixation on comparison simply falls away.
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CHAPTER 15

Be Who You Are

There is no rejection, only fit

“Why compete? No one else can ever be you.”

THE HEART OF IT

With the Divine as your source, no one’s good can take yours, so competition and rejection are mirages — people whose nature matches yours will find you, and the ones who don’t fall away; being real means a few people will be annoyed.

STORIES TO REMEMBER

- Three people begged her to help friends win “Spiritual Author of the Year” in an online contest; she balked at the oxymoron — “a smackdown between the Bhagavad Gita and the Bible? Buy your tickets here” — since a book written from a pure vibration finds everyone who needs it.
- Diane, shaken by one savage teaching evaluation among forty glowing ones (her class was “the biggest waste of time he’d known this entire incarnation”), heard Tosha reframe it: maybe his nature simply clashed with hers — and “if everyone loves you, you’re probably playing too safe.”
- On Haight Street, a Greenpeace canvasser kept calling women “ma’am” and getting nothing; Tosha coached him to drop it, then mused for the whole chapter on why the term rankles — women don’t “expire like bottles of milk.”
- Shavasana wisdom: imagining the world going on perfectly without you dissolves the desperate need to matter, and frees you to play your role with complete abandon.

TOSHA’S TAKEAWAYS

- 1 There’s no competition when the Divine is your source — one person’s success can’t diminish yours, and may even bolster it.
 - 2 Rejection is a mirage; people either fit you or they don’t, so stop trying to be liked by everyone.
 - 3 A little criticism can be a good sign — if you’re real, some people will bristle; playing safe just means you’re bland.
 - 4 Be unmistakably yourself; the people meant for you will find you by your own particular energy.
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CHAPTER 16

Be What the World Needs

Serve, send blessings, and trust the unfolding

“Sometimes the people with the most anger need the most help.”

THE HEART OF IT

Once the Divine is your source, your work becomes an act of love and service rather than a scramble for survival; send blessings even to those who hate you, share your gifts rather than hoard them, and rest in the deep trust that everything unfolds in its right time.

STORIES TO REMEMBER

- Mistaken in a Tribeca café for a man’s detested ex-wife (right down to the same sandals), Tosha watched him rage until she removed her sunglasses; his fury “had nothing to do with her” — a lesson that anger is often really about a childhood wound.
- A man in her spiritual group hated her on sight, so she lit a green candle and sent him love nightly; a month later he growled, “you used to bug the crap out of me and now I’m mad because I’m not mad” — “sometimes the angriest people need the most help.”
- The wayward yogini Mara, whose shrinking classes came from treating each student as her source; when she prayed to serve and let the Divine be her supply (“let all who need me find me”), her classes filled and she began offering free ones.
- The artist Sosa, whose bold “bird of paradise” work was hidden by false modesty and a wound-prone nature; Tosha urged her to let her ship set sail — “if you have something that can benefit others, it can be selfishness not to share.”

TOSHA’S TAKEAWAYS

- 1 Make your work service — let your bottom line belong to the Divine and serve with as much love as possible, and the funds arrive from wherever it picks.
- 2 Send blessings even to those who dislike you; you may be the only one on the planet winging good their way.
- 3 Share your gifts rather than hoard them — withholding what could help others is its own kind of theft.
- 4 Trust the unfolding: with God as your source you needn’t cling to any plan; rest in the quiet, bless the delays, and stay present to witness your own becoming.

PART TWO

The Action Guide

Surrender · Align · Embody

The wisdom of the sixteen chapters, reorganized into a practice you can actually work. Three phases carry you from letting go, to daily alignment, to living it out.

PHASE I

Surrender

Make the Divine your source

Stop trying to run your life on your own strength. Hand the outcome over, and let the Divine become your source.

Name your true Source

Each morning, consciously hand the day's outcomes to the Divine rather than to any person, job, market, or plan. When anxiety spikes about money or work, say inwardly, "You are my source. The economy is not." This single reframe lifts you above the turbulence.

Invoke Divine Order

Over any stuck problem, declare: "The perfect solution is already selected. I'll be guided to it at the right time, in the right way." Then release your grip on how it must arrive. Take action when leads appear, but stop strong-arming the result.

Build a God Box

Write each worry on a slip of paper and drop it into any container — the offering matters more than the words. When the worry returns, remember it's already handed over. Keep submitting a given worry for at least twenty-one days while the mind recalibrates.

Open your hand

Practice the prayer of non-grasping: "Let what wants to come come; let what wants to go go. If it's mine it will stay; if not, something better will replace it." Grasping is what makes you the slave of whatever you clutch.

Go straight to the top

When you're being bounced from department to department — in life or in spirit — stop pleading with those who lack the power. Address the Divine directly, as you would a friend who happens to run the whole storehouse. (And yes, you still have to make the actual call.)

Create space before you ask

Once a week, take an unplanned few hours with your phone off and let intuition lead — a walk, a drive, a ferry ride. Offer it over: "Bring what's most healing and necessary." Solutions to tangled problems tend to surface in the open space.

PHASE II

Align

Keep your vibration high; clear the channel

Surrender becomes a daily practice. Follow the leads, trade worry for blessings, and clear whatever blocks the flow.

Follow the inner tug

Learn to feel the palpable pull toward the next right step, even when logic argues against it. Ask for a clear sign before deciding — and add, “If I’m about to head the wrong way, please stop me.”

Trade every worry for a blessing

The instant you catch yourself fearing for someone you love, switch: hold them in light, see them peaceful and content, and do it day after day. Worry transmits fear; blessing transmits help.

Practice metta

Sit, follow the breath, and pour loving-kindness first to yourself, then to those you love, then to the difficult, then to the whole world. In any tense line or waiting room, silently bless everyone present and watch the atmosphere shift.

Clean the karma

To release a toxic tie, work the sequence: write the unsent letter (hold nothing back), burn it, take a strong Epsom-salt bath imagining the cords dissolving, cleanse with sage, release the person’s objects, pray for closure, and — hardest and most important — send them blessings. Repeat until you feel complete.

Create an intentional vacuum

Clear the clutter from your home, car, purse, and wallet so the new good has somewhere to land. If a decision is agonizing, pray to be shown what to keep and what to release, and let even a messy drawer become an offering: “As this is sorted, so am I.”

Guard the seedling

When a new life is sprouting — a job search, a healing, a fresh start — protect it from others’ fear and negativity. You cannot indulge anxiety and germinate a miracle at the same time. Don’t drink other people’s poison, even when it’s offered with love.

Refuse forced manifestation

Never try to commandeer what isn’t meant to be yours; will-forced outcomes turn poisonous. Replace “I must have that exact one” with “bring the one that’s right for me.”

PHASE III

Embody

Become who you are; serve; trust

The path comes home to you. Take back your power, be unmistakably yourself, serve with love, and rest in the unfolding.

Find door number three

When someone attacks, skip both collapse and counterattack; recognize that their rage is rarely about you, and answer with compassion. Most anger is an old wound screaming in disguise.

Free the inner hostage

Take back the power you've handed to a controlling parent, a draining friend, a fortune-teller, or your own past. Do a releasing ritual if you need one — but know that only you can finally break the barricade.

Drop the victim story

Stop narrating yourself as rejected or dumped, and stop comparing yourself to anyone. The receptive mind believes whatever you tell it, so speak your worth — “pretend” you're at peace with who you are until it becomes true.

Say what you mean

In an age of lies, make your word match your actions. Tell the truth in relationships with as much kindness and clarity as you can; staying in a dead union “to spare” someone only hobbles you both.

Be your whole, contradictory self

Embrace every conflicting part of your nature and live its highest octave — eagle and phoenix, not stinging scorpion. Express the music of your own soul and let comparison fall away.

Make your work an act of love

Let your bottom line belong to the Divine and serve with as much love as possible; competition is a mirage, because the people meant for your gift will find you. Share what you have rather than hoard it.

Rest in the unfolding

Trust that things are arriving at exactly the rate and timing they need. Bless the delays, stop clutching the ego's list, and stay present — detached yet riveted — to witness your own becoming.

Quick Reference

Sixteen principles to keep close. Print it, pin it, return to it.

- 01 Are You My Mother?.** Make the Divine your source, and hold everything else with an open hand.
- 02 Shopping with God.** Stop doing it “without God”; invoke Divine Order and let go.
- 03 When You Know the One, Anything Can Come.** The Divine is your one source; forgiveness reopens the flow.
- 04 Following the Inner Lead.** Offer your worries to the God Box and follow the breadcrumbs.
- 05 Giving It All Up — The Death Advisor.** Let death be your advisor; release everything, and grace flows.
- 06 Be What You Seek.** Your word is your law; embody abundance now, and never call yourself broke.
- 07 The Holiday Emergency Survival Kit.** Honor the inner tug and ask for a clear sign.
- 08 When in Doubt, Clean the Karma.** Release toxic ties and clear the clutter so good can enter.
- 09 Objects in Mirror Are Closer Than They Appear.** Trade worry for blessings; never force an outcome by will.
- 10 Own Your Power (Or Someone Else Will).** Another’s rage isn’t about you; your answers live inside you.
- 11 Romantic Kismet — Marrying Kali.** If it’s bashert it will come; be yourself and tell the truth.
- 12 Mundane Miracles and Other Mysteries.** Invite a miracle; bless the delays that may be saving your life.
- 13 Contestants Must Be Present to Win.** Stop chasing mirages; be present right where you are.
- 14 The Higher Octave.** Embrace your contradictions and live your highest octave.
- 15 Be Who You Are.** There’s no rejection, only fit; be real even if a few bristle.
- 16 Be What the World Needs.** Make your work love and service, and rest in the unfolding.

THE CLOSING RECITATION

The Principles of Outrageous Openness

- 01** The perfect solution to any problem is already selected; I will be guided to it at the right time, in the right way.
- 02** The Divine is my only source — no person, place, or job — so the universe can meet my needs through anything it chooses.
- 03** I move through the world with an open hand: let what wants to come come, and what wants to go go. If it is mine, it stays.
- 04** I offer my worries up rather than gripping them; when my mind stops grasping, the answer arrives.
- 05** I ask for signs, and I follow the breadcrumbs as they appear.
- 06** I make no decision from fear.
- 07** Forgiveness sets me free; I release resentment so the flow of good can reach me.
- 08** Instead of worry, I send blessings — to those I love, to strangers, to the difficult, and to myself.
- 09** I never force an outcome by will; I call in Divine Order and let the right thing come.
- 10** I am abundance now; my word is my law, so I never call myself broke.
- 11** My answers live inside me; I take back the power I hand to others.
- 12** With the Divine as my source, there is no rejection and no competition — I simply become who I am, and rest in the unfolding.